Australian Government
Australian Sports Commission

AIS

Community Perceptions Monitor

Key Data Update – March 2026

Current results are 2025-26 Financial Year to date

The ASC's vision: ***Sport has a place for everyone and delivers results to make Australians proud***

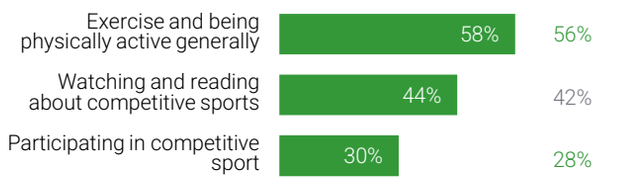
SUMMARY INDICES (Component questions from the survey consolidated into scores out of 100)

Pride	Inspiration	OPC* Pride	OPC* Inspiration	Value and benefits of sport
56 /100	42 /100	61 /100	48 /100	70 /100
FY 24-25: 55	42	59	48	69

*Olympic, Paralympic and Commonwealth Games athletes and teams

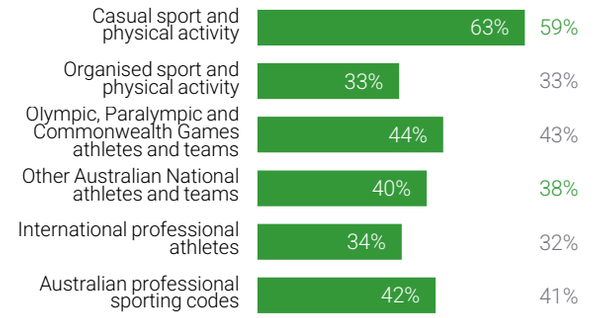
ENGAGEMENT WITH SPORT AND PHYSICAL ACTIVITY

Enjoyment of sports
(% I like it or I love it)

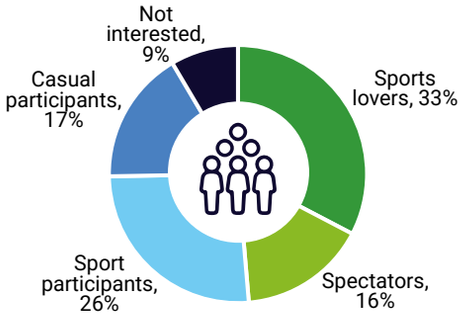


Australians were physically active on **3.4 days** per week on average (FY 24-25: 3.3 days)

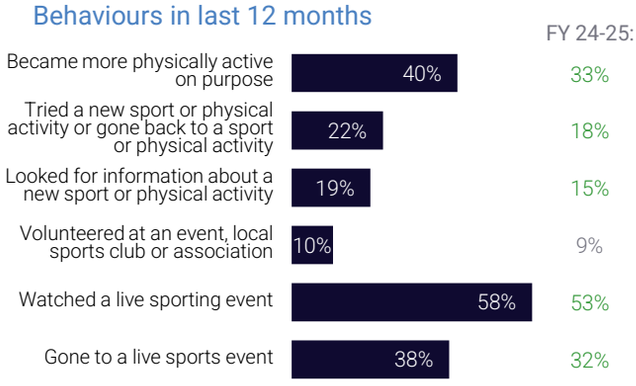
Interest in sports categories
(% Very or extremely interested)



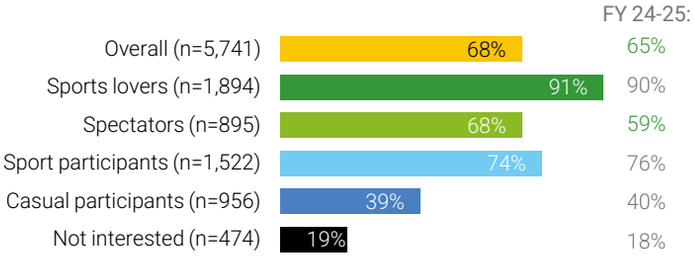
Community segments



Behaviours in last 12 months



Involvement in sport in last 12 months
(% of each segment involved in sport in *any* way)



30% Players or participants

14% Volunteers

46% Spectators

25% Other involvement (e.g. official, parent, administrator)

Overall satisfaction with life (% rated 8, 9 or 10)

46% Actively involved in sport

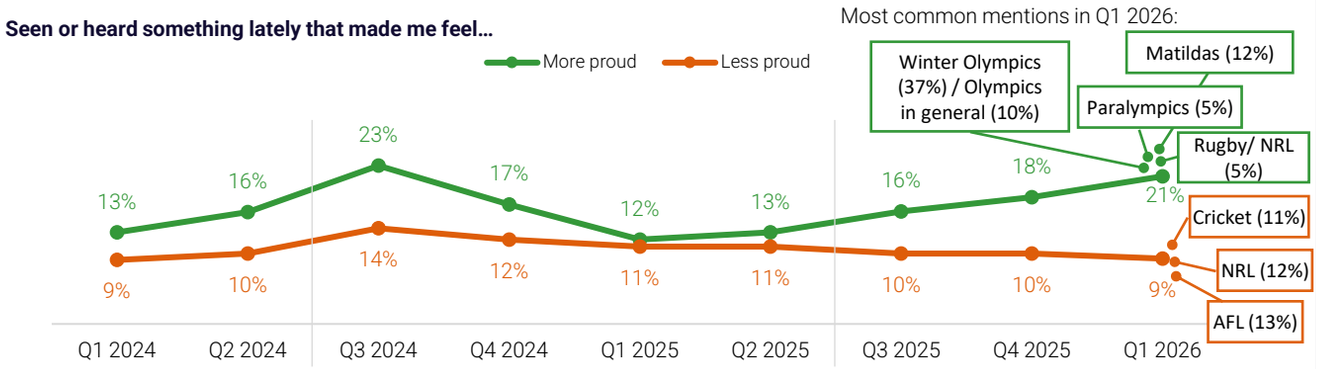
40% Not involved in sport

ORIMA

Note: Coloured FY24-25 comparison figures indicate significant differences compared to FY25-26

FEELINGS ABOUT AUSTRALIAN SPORT

Seen or heard something lately that made me feel...

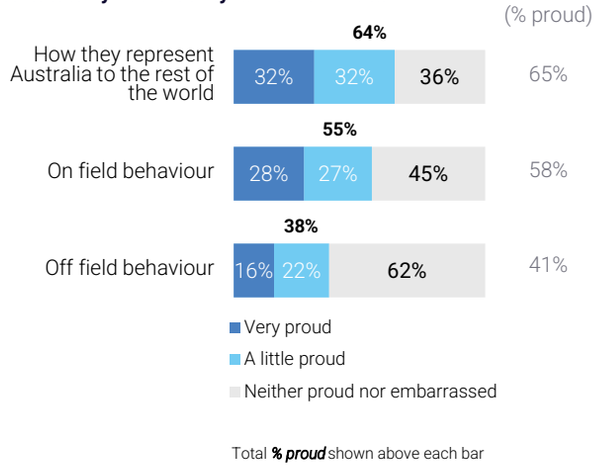


Pride	Inspiration		Worthiness of investment		Inclusiveness of sport	Value and benefits of sport
83%	74%	76%	59%	63%	77%	86%
FY 24-25: 82%	73%	75%	57%	68%	77%	85%
Say Olympic, Paralympic and Commonwealth Games athletes can make them feel proud *(extremely + a lot + quite a bit)*	Say Olympic, Paralympic and Commonwealth Games athletes can make them feel inspired *(extremely + a lot + quite a bit)*	Feel that Australia's elite athletes are some of the best role models for kids and young people to aspire to	Provision of government/ public funding for sport and physical activity in Australia is extremely or very worthwhile	Governments have invested in enough in sport and physical activity opportunities to keep their community engaged and healthy	Sport is inclusive for all Australians	Have a high level of understanding of the value and benefits of sport

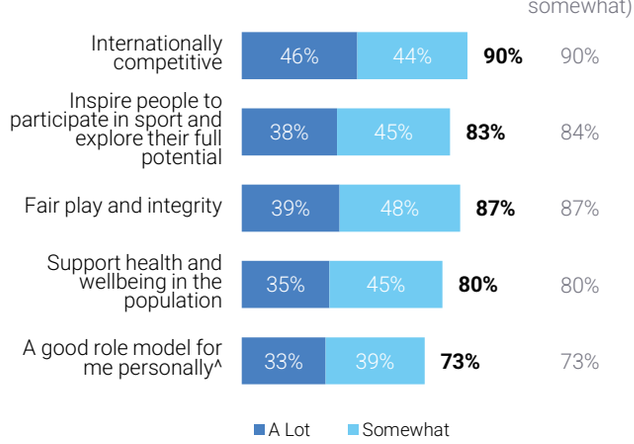
WE WIN WELL TO INSPIRE AUSTRALIANS

The sport sector's Win Well strategy has a vision that ***We win well to inspire Australians***. Data from the CPM can help ascertain how well this mission resonates in the community.

How have you felt lately about OPC* athletes...



At the moment, how much do you think the characteristics below describe OPC* athletes?



*Olympic, Paralympic and Commonwealth Games athletes and teams

^Response scale uses 'A great deal' instead of 'A lot'

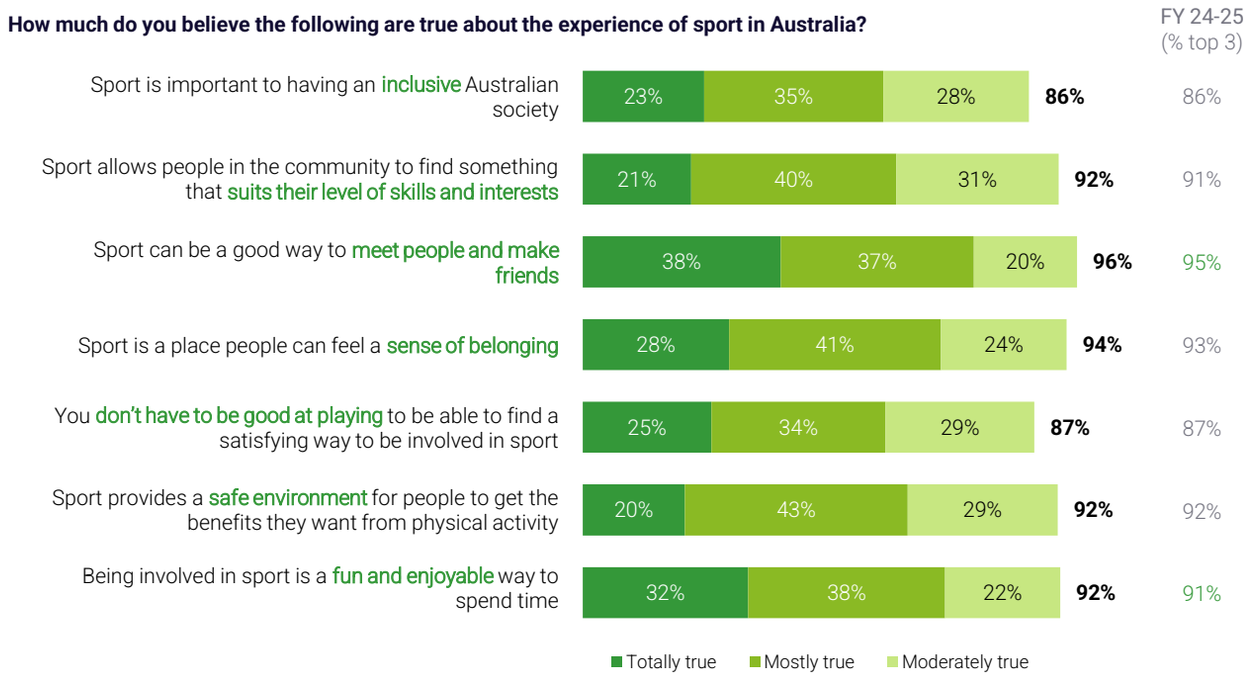
Note: Coloured FY24-25 comparison figures indicate significant differences compared to FY25-26

SPORT HAS A PLACE FOR EVERYONE

The sport sector's Play Well strategy has a vision that ***Sport has a place for everyone*** and a mission to ***create safe, welcoming, inclusive and fun sporting experiences***. Data from the CPM can help ascertain how well this mission is being achieved.

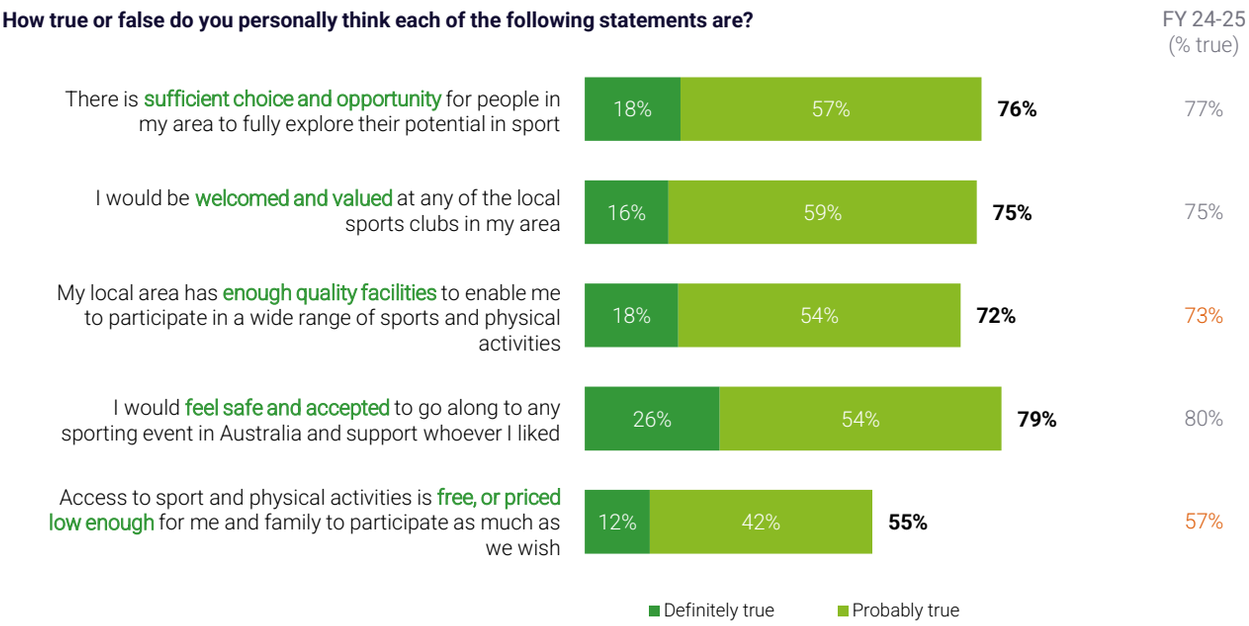
Value and benefits of sport

How much do you believe the following are true about the experience of sport in Australia?



Inclusiveness

How true or false do you personally think each of the following statements are?



Note: Coloured FY24-25 comparison figures indicate significant differences compared to FY25-26

NOTES ON BACKGROUND AND METHODOLOGY

The Community Perceptions Monitor (CPM) is a monthly online survey of the general community about sport and physical activity in Australia. The CPM surveys 500 adults each month across metropolitan and regional Australia. This report shows the results of key metrics from the CPM for the 2025-26 Financial Year to date and the 2024-25 Financial Year (FY 24-25).

SPORTS CATEGORIES

The research measures perceptions of six different types of sports categories, defined as below:



Casual sport and physical activity – Unstructured sport or physical activity that you can do at any time or place during the day, by yourself or with family/friends (e.g. jogging, walking the dog, going to the gym, playing cricket in the park with friends, etc.).



Organised sport and physical activity – Structured organised sport ranging from A-grade club sport through to more social and junior sport, as well as all the types of organised physical activity that people do (e.g. boot camp, gym classes, dance classes, etc.).



Olympic, Paralympic and Commonwealth Games (OPC athletes) – Athletes who represent Australia at these events every four years.



Other Australian national athletes and teams – Athletes competing as Australia in international sport at World Championships, World Cups, etc (excluding the Olympics, Paralympics and Commonwealth Games).



International professional athletes – Australian athletes playing professional sport around the globe (as an individual athlete or as part of a team) in competitions and events that include international events but they do not compete as Australia



Australian professional sporting codes – All the codes of sport within Australia that men and women play where they are paid, at least to some extent, to play (e.g. AFL, AFLW, NRL, NBL, WNBL, etc.)

For some questions in the survey, respondents were randomly allocated to answer about just one of these sport categories. Hence, perceptions of each sports category were only measured among a subset of respondents each month for those questions.

COMMUNITY SEGMENTS

In the baseline research, five segments were identified in the community. Members of each segment are primarily distinguished by their interest in and enjoyment of sport and physical activity, self-reported levels of activity, and a distinction between competitive sport and physical activity.

The five segments are:



Sports lovers – Have the highest interest in and enjoyment of both competitive sport and physical activity, and are the most active.



Spectators – More interested in watching competitive sport than in competing themselves, and relatively less active than most.



Casual participants – Also quite active, but much more interested in physical activity than they are in competitive sport.



Sports participants – Quite active, highly interested in casual sport and physical activity, and as interested in participating in competitive sport as they are in watching it.



Not interested – Least active, and least interested in any type of sport or physical activity.

SUMMARY MEASURES

The Community Perceptions Monitor contains a number of individual elements that relate to broader overarching concepts. From these individual elements, multi dimensional summary measures are calculated to track changes over time, including Pride, Inspiration and Value and Benefits of Sport indices. The indices are calculated on a 0-100 scale and reflect both the distribution of responses and the strength of responses, with the strongest responses to individual questions contributing most to the index calculations.

A summary of how the summary measures are calculated below:

- **Index scores** – Points assigned based on responses to a range of statements about sport pride, inspiration and the value and benefits of sport weighted by individual questions
- **Understanding of the Value and Benefits of Sport** – Percentage of respondents who rate 13 or more of the 16 statements as totally, mostly or moderately true